speedily. Plans were drawn up for rolling stock and infrastructure for the Bombay–Poona/Igatpuri/Vasai and the Madras–Tambaram routes. The Secretary of State for India sanctioned it in October 1920. A 1500 Direct Current (DC) power source was adopted for its higher start-up power and easy speed control. The power was to be supplied by Tata for traction purpose, and the GIP Railway also built its in-house power-generating plant at Thakurli near Bombay. All the infrastructure that was required to build an electric railway, except for the power supply, was imported from various companies in England.

India's first electric train ran between Bombay (Victoria Terminus) and Kurla, a distance of 16 km, on Tuesday, 3 February 1925, inaugurated by the Bombay governor, Sir Leslie Orme Wilson (governor from December 1923–March 1926).

> There had been initial plans to inaugurate the service on 1 January, from Sandhurst Road to Kurla, but it was later postponed to 3 February to complete electrification works and include Victoria Terminus (VT) station. The inaugural function was held on Platform 2 of VT station and Sir and Lady Wilson were received by little Miss Idina Powell, the daughter of Mr Powell, head trial driver from Parel's mechanical department. The line was thrown open after Sir Wilson signalled the power sub-station at Wadi Bunder to throw the conductor wire into the circuit to commence the public service. [94]

Sir Wilson's name was later given to one of the first electric freight locomotives on Indian soil in 1928, classified as EF/1 [95] and later as WCG–1. They were built by Swiss Locomotive and Machine Works with electrical equipment by Metropolitan Vickers, England, and were useful on the strenuous Ghat sections. The locomotives have been phased out a long time ago, but one of them, titled Sir Leslie Wilson, is displayed at the National Railway Museum .

> The first railway, electrified on a 1,500 volts DC, was powered by Tata and Sons who had set up a hydroelectric plant. The power was delivered from the Tata Mains to sub-stations at Dharavi, Thana and Kalyan at a normal pressure of 22,000 volts. From Dharavi, the supply was transmitted to railway sub stations at Kurla and Wadi Bunder by means of underground cables. The electric coaches (electric multiple units) that had arrived a month before to be run on the line were then the widest in India, with 12 feet width and 68 feet length. Each unit with four coaches, including a motor coach attached with automatic couplers, was capable of running at a speed of 50 miles per hour, smoke-free! The third class coach had ninety-six seats each. They were provided by Cammell Laird and the 1898-founded German train builder Uerdingen Wagonfabrik. [96]